

ZACHARY BUTLER

Producer/Editor

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🌐 ctrlz.cc

SOCIAL

in zachary-butler

PROFILE

Creative Producer/Editor with 10+ years of experience leading end-to-end video production for educational and mission-driven organizations. Specializes in documentary storytelling, post-production craft, and accessibility-compliant deliverables for digital and social platforms.

SKILLS

Technical Proficiency

- ▶ Adobe Premiere Pro
- ▶ Adobe After Effects
- ▶ Adobe Photoshop
- ▶ Adobe Audition
- ▶ DaVinci Resolve
- ▶ Frame.io
- ▶ Google Suite

Core Competencies

- ▶ Video Editing & Post-Production
- ▶ Documentary Storytelling

EXPERIENCE

FOUNDER / PRODUCER

2025 - Present | Lesson Zero Studio | Laramie, WY

Founded a boutique video production studio; own end-to-end process from concept and casting through directing, multi-camera shoots (Sony A7SII, Nikon Z-series), editing, color grading in Premiere Pro, and final delivery

Produced commercial campaigns for clients including Zembla, managing audition pipelines, brand-aligned visual development, and post-production targeting client-specific aesthetics

INSTRUCTIONAL MEDIA PRODUCER

2021 - 2025 | Cornell University

Led end-to-end documentary production — from concept and stakeholder discovery through scripting, shoots, editing, color grading, and final delivery — for Cornell's student-experience video portfolio

Partnered with faculty, instructional designers, and university communications to translate institutional priorities into compelling visual narratives optimized for web and social distribution

Ensured accessibility compliance on all video deliverables (closed captions, transcripts, formatting) in line with Cornell's accessibility guidelines

Managed post-production pipeline (sound design, color correction) and digital asset organization on shared media servers; trained and mentored student production assistants in shooting and editing workflows

Drove a 5x increase in views and 2x increase in subscribers for the department YouTube channel through narrative refinement and platform-optimized formatting

EDITOR

2017 - 2020 | FBE, INC

Edited 2-3 videos per week averaging 1-2M views for the REACT and REPLAY YouTube channels — both short-form and long-form formats optimized for digital distribution

Finalized episodes with sound design, color correction, and motion graphics

Developed and implemented new post-production workflows that improved editor and assistant editor efficiency department-wide

▶ Sound Design & Color Correction

▶ Accessibility Compliance (Captions & Transcripts)

▶ Collaborative Production

▶ Digital Asset Management

LANGUAGES

English — Native

French — Elementary proficiency. Six years of academic coursework; conversational ability rusty but recoverable.

EDUCATION

MASTER OF ARTS

2008 - 2010 | University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee

Film, Television, and New Media Studies

BACHELOR OF ARTS

2004 - 2008 | University of Montevallo

English Literature

EDITOR

2015 - 2017 | DEFY Media

Edited videos for DEFY MEDIA brands including Smosh, Warp Zone, and Clevver TV

Specialized in branded content for major clients including Google, Sony, Kellogg's, and Blizzard Entertainment

Collaborated with producers to incorporate notes from clients, producers, and executives

ADJUNCT INSTRUCTOR

2010 - 2013 | University of Montevallo

Taught three courses per semester as sole instructor, including first-year composition (100-level) and literature survey courses (200-level), with class sizes of 24-30 students

Designed syllabi, assignments, and assessments independently for all courses, including a special topics course on time travel in literature and film

Guided students through iterative writing processes with emphasis on revision, feedback, and developing critical thinking skills

PRODUCER/EDITOR - FREELANCE

2013 - 2024 | Various Clients

Caltech - Faculty video bios, fundraising content, and social media for an academic institution

Wizards of the Coast - Edited videos for Magic: The Gathering channel

Burning Sofa - Podcast and social media video production

Lemonlight - Edited digital advertisements for Zircon hardware

FEATURED PROJECT

MAC DRE: LEGEND OF THE BAY

2015 | Producer, Director, Editor

Documentary chronicling the life and legacy of Bay Area rapper Mac Dre

Audience Choice Award, San Francisco Black Film Festival